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Volume 39, 2020 - Issue 2

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ORIGINAL RESEARCH

Effect of New Zealand Blackcurrant on Blood Pressure, Cognitive Function and Functional Performance in Older Adults

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Pages 99-113 | Published online: 06 Jan 2020

 Cite this article  <https://doi.org/10.1080/21551197.2019.1707740>[Full Article](#) [Figures & data](#) [References](#) [Citations](#) [Metrics](#)[Reprints & Permissions](#) [Read this article](#)

Abstract

New Zealand blackcurrant (NZBC) can increase exercise performance in young adults, potentially by anthocyanin-induced cardiovascular function alterations and increased blood flow, however, effects upon blood pressure, functional exercise performance and cognitive function in older adults is unknown. In a randomized, double-blind, placebo-controlled, cross-over design, 14 older adults (age: 69 ± 4 years, height: 172 ± 9 cm, body mass: 85 ± 12) ingested NZBC extract ($600 \text{ mg} \cdot \text{day}^{-1}$ CurraNZ™) or placebo (PL, 600 mg microcrystalline cellulose) for 7-days (7-day washout between conditions). On day-7, 2-hours following consumption of the capsules, resting blood pressure, cognitive function (Cambridge neuropsychological test automated battery) and 6-minute walk test performance and were measured. Intake of NZBC caused a decrease ($p < 0.05$) in systolic (PL: 136 ± 14 ; NZBC: 130 ± 12 mmHg) and diastolic (PL: 84 ± 11 ;

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performance or cognitive function variables. Future research should address optimization of intake and examine cardiovascular responses during exercise.

Q Keywords: [Anthocyanins](#) [cognitive function](#) [functional performance](#) [New Zealand blackcurrant](#) [older adults](#)

[◀ Previous article](#)[View issue table of contents](#)[Next article ▶](#)

Acknowledgment

Supply of supplement (CurraNZ™) for this study was donated from Health Currancy Ltd (United Kingdom).

Disclosure statement

The authors declare no conflict of interest.

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